Herbert *Gracia*

Head of Brand & Creative

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Seeking: Head of Brand · Creative Director · Art Director · Director of Marketing & Communications · Brand Strategy & Growth

I build brands, lead creative teams, and turn ideas into *experiences that connect.*

Creative leader and entrepreneur with 20+ years in brand strategy, creative direction, art direction, and integrated marketing. I co-founded and exited two apparel brands, FAZE Apparel (full acquisition) and State of Flux (partner buyout), building DTC, e-commerce, wholesale, and B2B sales. Today, as Assistant Director at the University of San Francisco's Fromm Institute, I lead brand, marketing, communications, PR, and technology with a team of 6+, $150K+ in annual budgets, and cross-functional projects.

2Brands co-founded & exited · 10%Enrollment growth at Fromm in 2 years · 500+News outlets ran my national press release · $150K+Annual budgets managed

EXPERIENCE

2022–Present
San Francisco

Assistant Director, Technology, Marketing & Creative · *Fromm Institute for Lifelong Learning, University of San Francisco*

Lead a team of 6+ staff and 20+ volunteers across brand strategy, creative direction, marketing, PR, and technology for USF's nonprofit, higher-education lifelong learning institute (3,000 students a year), working closely with a 21-member Board of Directors.

- **Creative & Brand Leadership:** Lead creative direction, art direction, visual identity, and brand storytelling; design the layout of every publication, course catalog, brochure, newsletter, and print ad; designed the 50th Anniversary logo and campaign.
- **Enrollment Marketing & Growth:** Built Fromm's marketing from zero into a multi-channel enrollment program (Google, Meta, and LinkedIn ads, social media, email, PR, community partnerships), growing enrollment 10% in 2 years.
- **Public & Media Relations:** Ran a lifelong learning survey and wrote its national press release (PR Newswire), picked up by 500+ news outlets; leading the 50th Anniversary PR campaign.
- **Advertising & Media Buying:** Manage a $20K-a-year newspaper ad account with Hearst Media (San Francisco Chronicle, SFGATE), designing every ad, plus $3K a month in paid social.
- **Product & Technology:** Built Frommcast, a subscription streaming platform ("Netflix for lifelong learning") with 3,000+ active users and monthly paying subscribers, later moved to YouTube (700+ subscribers in 6 months).
- **Technology & Operations:** Led the Salesforce website and CRM with online enrollment and payments (Stripe, CashNet), hybrid learning, and AI applications; manage a $100K-a-year technology budget, on budget every year.

Earlier roles here:

- Specialist, Instructional Technology & Media, 2019–2022
- Instructional Technology Manager, 2012–2019
- Program Manager, 2005–2012

2019–2024
San Francisco Bay Area

Co-Founder & Brand Director · *State of Flux*

EXIT: PARTNER BUYOUT · 2024

Co-founded and developed an independent apparel and lifestyle brand alongside my full-time role at Fromm, overseeing creative direction, brand strategy, product development, marketing,

and retail operations.

- Designed original products, from embroidered caps and graphic hoodies to upcycled jersey totes, plus our retail store and pop-up spaces.
- Led brand identity, creative direction, campaigns, photography, and e-commerce.
- Built brand partnerships with Pinterest, Timbuk2, and SFMOMA, creating co-branded products for sale plus events and pop-ups.
- Oversaw direct-to-consumer (DTC), e-commerce, wholesale, B2B, and retail sales while managing a team of five.

Sold my ownership stake to my business partner in 2024.

2007–2019

San Francisco

Co-Founder & Brand Director · *FAZE Apparel*

EXIT: FULL COMPANY ACQUISITION · 2019

Co-founded and built an apparel business from initial concept, alongside my role at Fromm, leading brand development, creative direction, marketing, retail strategy, and business operations.

- Art-directed apparel graphics, lookbooks, photography, video, and retail creative.
- Expanded wholesale distribution to more than 10 retail locations, and designed and opened our branded retail store.
- Led trade-show and experiential marketing initiatives in Las Vegas, Miami, Los Angeles, and New York.
- Led a team of five across design, product, marketing, and sales; managed sampling, sourcing, materials, manufacturing, quality control, and production.

The company was acquired by a privately held business, including its brand assets, logos, designs, and intellectual property rights.

CERTIFICATIONS

Certificate in Applied Agentic AI

UNIVERSITY OF SAN FRANCISCO · 2026 · COMPLETED

Also: **AI Certificate Intensive**, 2026 · Completed

EDUCATION

University of San Francisco, B.A., Media Studies and Communication; Minor in Film, 2005

SKILLS

CREATIVE LEADERSHIP	Creative Direction · Art Direction · Visual Identity · Design Leadership
BRAND & STORYTELLING	Brand Strategy · Brand Management · Content Strategy · Campaign Development
MARKETING & GROWTH	Integrated Marketing · Digital Marketing · Public Relations (PR) · Enrollment Marketing
EXECUTIVE & BUSINESS LEADERSHIP	Team Leadership · Budget & Vendor Management · Strategic Planning · Business Development
AI & TECHNOLOGY	Applied Agentic AI · AI-Powered Automation · Salesforce · Marketing Technology
PRODUCT & GROWTH	Product Development · Go-to-Market Strategy · DTC & E-commerce · Brand Partnerships
LANGUAGES	English (full professional) · Spanish (full professional)

TOOLS Adobe Creative Cloud / Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, Premiere Pro) · Figma · Final Cut Pro · Canva · Salesforce & Marketing Cloud · Mailchimp · Google Analytics · Claude · ChatGPT · GitHub · Cloudflare